HTML from Scratch

Course summary | Instructor: Dave Gray

A short summary of the course: the structure of a web page, from text and links to semantic tags, tables and forms.

Week 1-2

Getting Started

HTML describes structure using elements made of tags. A page starts with <!DOCTYPE html>, then <html lang="en"> containing <head> and <body>. Save the file as .html and open it in a browser.

Head and Text

The <head> holds the <title>, <meta charset="utf-8"> and the viewport meta tag. In the body use headings h1 to h6 (one h1 per page), paragraphs p, strong and em.

Lists and Links

Use ul for bullet lists, ol for numbered lists and li for items. Links use <a href="..."> with clear text. With target="_blank" also add rel="noopener".

Images

Use <img src alt width height>. The alt text describes the image (leave it empty for decorative images). Width and height prevent layout shifts, and loading="lazy" delays offscreen images.

Week 3-4

Semantic Tags

header, nav, main, article, section, aside and footer describe the meaning of content. They help accessibility and SEO. Use div only when no semantic tag fits.

Tables

Tables use table, tr, th and td, grouped with thead and tbody, and a caption. Use tables for data, never for layout. The scope attribute on th helps screen readers.

Forms and Inputs

A form contains inputs. Link each label to its field with for and id. Input types include text, email, password and checkbox. Add name so the value is submitted, and required for validation.

Final Project

Combine everything in one page: a header with navigation, main content, an image, a list or table, a contact form and a footer. Check heading order and alt text, then validate the HTML.

Quick reference

<a href>	Create a link
<img alt>	Image with a description

<label for>	Name a form field
<main>	The main page content
<meta name="viewport">	Mobile-friendly scaling